about the third time I said that, the guard spoke up and said: “Governor, we don’t fire warning shots. I just missed the bastard.”

Not long after that, I went to Modesto, an agricultural town in the lush San Joaquin Valley where local people had put on a successful campaign to raise money for a new medical center and had invited me to speak at the dedication banquet. We were still at the height of the campus rioting and the administration was doing other things that hadn’t made me popular, including an effort to reform California’s welfare system, and our security people told me they didn’t think it was a good time for me to leave Sacramento. But I’d given my word I’d go, and insisted we do so.

When we got to Modesto, there were four different groups of placard-waving people demonstrating outside the building against me. While I was inside giving my speech, I learned later, a citizen reported to the police that a suspicious-acting man had been repeatedly circling the building and stopping every so often to ask people which door I was going to use after the banquet.

This alarmed the police and sheriff’s deputies, who couldn’t find the man, and a real dragnet was put into action. Finally, someone spotted the man in a car slowly circling the block again and again; the next time he came around, the police pulled him over, yanked him out of the car, and bent him face down over the hood of his car as they frisked him.

He realized pretty quickly what was going on: “No, no, no,” he said, “you fellows have it all wrong. I just want to *see* the son of a bitch.”

In a country ruled by laws, it seemed to me that nothing was more important than removing politics from the process of choosing judges. During previous administrations in California, governors had often handed out judgeships to friends and cronies like prizes at a company picnic. Not only